

Educational Comic Guidelines

Self-Assessment for Authors, Artists, and Educators

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Development

- ☐ **Context and Learner Analysis**
Analyze the educational context as well as learner knowledge and needs prior to development to guide design choices.
- ☐ **Goal Orientation**
Plan the comic around what learners should know or be able to do after interacting with it.
- ☐ **Self-Contained and Versatile Design**
Develop the comic to be self-sufficient and easily adaptable for various contexts, audiences or educational purposes.
- ☐ **Evaluation and Revision**
Evaluate and revise the comic regularly based on feedback, research, and evolving educational needs to ensure effectiveness.

Structure and Format

- ☐ **Conversational Language**
Use simple, authentic, and conversational language that is appropriate for the learner's level when technical terms are not required.
- ☐ **Conciseness and Segmentation**
Keep the comic as well as the text short and focused, and break longer sections into clear, standalone segments.
- ☐ **Task Progression**
Provide questions, tasks and activities about the comic's content that progressively increase in difficulty, accompanied by clear instructions and assessment criteria.

Content

- ☐ **Content Integrity and Compliance**
Include content that is accurate, appropriately cited, and legally compliant.
- ☐ **Structured Narrative**
Frame the comic as a narrative with a logical and continuous story progression containing a clear beginning, middle, and conclusion.

- ☐ **Engaging Characters**
Narrate the content through a few expressive and well-defined human or personified characters.
- ☐ **Real-World Context**
Employ realistic, representative, and relevant examples grounded in real life and industry contexts.

Visual Design

- ☐ **Limited and Consistent Typography**
Use a limited and consistent set of fonts and text formatting to support, enhance and stimulate reading.
- ☐ **Purposeful Color Usage**
Apply color purposefully and consistently, keeping the color palette balanced and limited.
- ☐ **Visual Emphasis and Focus**
Utilize contrast, visual hierarchy and cues to emphasize essential content and guide the learner's focus to it.
- ☐ **Visual Balance and Spacing**
Ensure a balanced layout with sufficient white space to avoid clutter and maintain visual harmony.
- ☐ **Sequential Clarity**
Place text next to relevant imagery while arranging elements such as panels, captions, and speech balloons carefully to establish a clear reading sequence.

Deployment

- ☐ **Support through Repetition**
Use the comic as a complementary and assistive tool in delivering the content, enhancing retention through effective repetition.
- ☐ **Personal Relevance and Motivation**
Ensure the comic conveys its real-world value and personal significance to learners, fostering motivation and personal involvement.
- ☐ **Attitude Formation**
Utilize the comic to promote confidence and ease in learners, fostering positive attitudes towards the subject.